MODULE 2 WORKSHEET

The Voice of Influence Emotional Preparation Worksheet

Use this worksheet before a negotiation or a difficult conversation. It takes 15–20 minutes. Fill in the parts that help; skip the rest.

Conversation I'm preparing for: _____ **Date:** _____

01 Pre-negotiation emotional checklist

Self-awareness first: you can't manage what you don't recognise.

What emotions am I bringing in today? (tired, anxious, frustrated, confident…)

What might trigger me in this conversation?

How do I want to show up? (three words)

02 Triggers and anchor phrases

IF THIS HAPPENS…	I'LL NOTICE IT IN MY BODY AS…	I'LL SAY OR DO… (ANCHOR PHRASE, BREATH, GROUNDING)
I'm interrupted or dismissed		
I feel a power imbalance		
A surprise objection or unreasonable demand		
My own trigger: _____		

Name & Reframe: "I'm feeling _____." → "This is a high-pressure moment, but not a personal threat." **4-7-8:** in 4 · hold 7 · out 8, three to four times. **Calm – Curious – Clear.**

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03 Allegation Assessment builder

Before the conversation, ask: **"What might they fear, assume or resent about me or my position?"** If they say it, it's a problem. If you say it first, it's connection.

#	WHAT THEY MIGHT FEAR, ASSUME OR RESENT	HOW I'LL NAME IT ("YOU MIGHT BE THINKING…", "IT MAY SEEM LIKE…", "YOU PROBABLY FEEL…")
1		
2		
3		

My opening: stack the concerns, in a calm, non-defensive tone, then end with a question or proposal.

Remember: you're not admitting guilt. You're showing you understand their concerns, which lowers tension and opens the door to real dialogue.

04 Emotional hot spots

Which topics are most likely to touch trust, respect, status, fairness, control or fear for them?

TOPIC	EMOTION IT MAY TOUCH	LABEL I COULD USE ("IT SOUNDS LIKE…")

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05 Decode, don't dismiss

Write the statements you expect to hear, the emotion that may sit underneath, and an emotionally intelligent response.

THEY MIGHT SAY…	POSSIBLE EMOTIONAL LAYER	MY RESPONSE
"We'll need to think about it."	Pressure, internal politics, distrust	"Of course. What concerns do you think your team might raise that we could address now?"

06 Voice plan

Which voice will you use, and when? Write the moment in the conversation where each one fits.

Assertive
Lead, set boundaries, pitch. Downward inflection, steady rhythm.

Midnight
Soothe, de-escalate, connect. Slow, low, soft; longer pauses.

Playful
Energise, build rapport. Upward inflection; smile while speaking.

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07 If it gets heated: the six-step flow

Script the key lines in advance so you can stay calm in the moment.

STEP	MY WORDS
1 · Midnight voice Calm, slow, measured	(no words needed: set your tone)
2 · "I'm sorry…" + acknowledgement	
3 · Label "It seems like you're feeling…"	
4 · Verbal mirror Repeat their key words	
5 · Silence Three seconds. Let it land.	
6 · Repeat Summarise their real need, restate your view	

08 After-action review

Fill this in within 24 hours of the conversation. Rate each EI skill from 1 to 5.

EI SKILL	1-5	EVIDENCE / WHAT I'D DO DIFFERENTLY
Self-awareness		
Self-regulation		
Social awareness		
Empathy		

The moment the emotional conversation shifted, and what caused it:

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